central puzzle of quantum physics.

Everett thought that measurement, as presented in von Neumann's textbook, was "a 'magic' process in which something quite drastic [occurs] (collapse of the wave function), while in all other times systems [are] assumed to obey perfectly natural continuous laws." Measurement shouldn't be fundamentally different from other physical processes. And even worse, according to Everett, von Neumann's approach doesn't even tell you what measurements are. If a measurement only happens when someone looks at a system, who, in particular, has to look? Everett argued that this line of reasoning leads inevitably to solipsism—the idea that you are the only being in the universe, and everyone else is somehow illusory or secondary, existing in states of indeterminate reality until you, the High Arbiter of Wave Function Collapse, deign to observe them. In his thesis, Everett admitted that this is an internally consistent view, but that "one must feel uneasy when, for example, writing textbooks on quantum mechanics, describing [wave function collapse], for the consumption of other persons to whom it does not apply."

Bohr's idea that the quantum world of the small obeyed entirely different rules from those that governed the classical world of the large offered a possible way out of this dilemma—but at the cost of a unified picture of the world free of contradiction, a price Everett was (justifiably) unwilling to pay. "The Copenhagen interpretation is hopelessly incomplete because of its a priori reliance on classical physics (excluding *in principle* any deduction of classical physics from quantum theory, or any adequate investigation of the measuring process)," Everett complained, "as well as a philosophic monstrosity with a 'reality' concept for the macroscopic world and denial of the same for the microcosm." Writing to Petersen, Everett stated his intentions quite clearly. "The time has come… to treat [quantum physics] in its own right as a fundamental theory without any dependence on classical physics, and to derive classical physics from it." Like Bohm before him, Everett wanted to take quantum physics seriously as a theory of the entire world.

Rejecting both von Neumann and Bohr, Everett came up with his own solution to the measurement problem. Rather than explaining wave function collapse, Everett stated that wave functions never collapse at all. This in itself was not new; Bohm said the same thing. But Bohm had also added